

MONITORS

CRT Monitors (17-Inch)

Acer AF715

Specs: 0.25 mm Dot Pitch, 1600 x 1200 Max Resolution @ 75Hz, 200 MHz Video Bandwidth

Our Verdict: The fine dot pitch of 0.25 mm, and the outstanding video bandwidth, makes this CRT the most remarkable 17-inch tube in its class. Clear colour image reproduction on a naturally flat screen with a highest resolution of 1600 x 1200 at a refresh rate of 75 Hz is not a

common feature among 17-inch tubes. The anti-reflective coating reduces glare and enhances picture viewing. The good picture clarity and these excellent specifications come at an affordable price.



Runner-Up: ViewSonic E71f

CRT monitors (19-Inch)

Samsung SyncMaster 997DF

Specs: 0.20 mm Dot Pitch, 1920 x 1440 @ 64Hz Maximum Resolution, Shadow Mask, 250 MHz Video Bandwidth

Our Verdict: This Samsung 19-inch CRT showcases consistent overall performance. Graphics professionals and gamers should take a look at this one, since it did not display any ghosting or streaking in our tests. Unfortunately, there are no factory-preset colour, contrast and bright-

ness settings for various viewing conditions such as dim ambient light.

The flat-screen 997DF is reasonably priced, and is an attractive option for those looking to migrate to a quality big-screen monitor.



Runner-Up: Samsung SyncMaster 957MB

LCD Monitors (15-inch)

Acer AL1512

Specs: 450:1 Contrast Ratio, 350 cd/m2 Luminance, 23 ms Response Time, Inbuilt Speakers

Our Verdict: The Acer AL1512 blends good performance with great features at a decent price tag. Other than the price advantage, the AL1512 sports good viewing angles. Colour reproduction is excellent, the picture is sharp, and the high luminance assures screen visibility even in bright ambient light. The 23 ms response time may not be the best for gaming and movie watching, though.

Common features such as a VESA wall mount and D-Sub and stereo pin input types are present. It's also PC and Mac compatible!



Runner-Up: CMV CT-529A

Netgear MP101 Wireless Digital Music Player

If you want the music on your computer to be playing in your bedroom or living room—assuming the PC is in some other room—and you don't want to create audio CDs or MP3 CDs for your music system because your song collection is too large, then you're looking for the Netgear MP 101 Wireless Digital Music Player.

The MP101 is a wireless device that can stream music from your PC, sending the output to the speakers connected to the device. There's a large

LCD panel on the front to display the song details, and no buttons; all functions are controlled via the feature-rich remote.

Setting up the device is not a problem, but you need to have a Wi-Fi card on your PC. The MP 101 comes with an audio RCA jack, stereo-in pin for speakers, and an RJ45 LAN port to connect to a LAN switch if you are using one. Set up an Access Point on your PC running server software that configures DHCP connections for its clients, and the MP101 will look for a server, and gain an IP address and subnet mask by itself... all you have to do is choose your music and hit 'Play'!

